Adonay Lizardo

Design Leadership | Product Strategy | AI-Enabled Design Operations

Venezuela | 100% Remote | America/Caracas (UTC-4) | Bilingual English/Spanish

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Design leader and product strategist experienced in directing design work, mentoring designers, building capability programs, and aligning distributed teams around product outcomes. Leads enterprise product design and UX consulting while developing AI-enabled design operations that connect evidence, specifications, prototyping, review, and engineering handoff. Combines hands-on product leadership with long-standing teaching and career coaching experience in English- and Spanish-speaking remote environments.

CORE EXPERTISE

Design Leadership; Product Strategy; Team Mentoring and Capability Building; Mentoring-Program Development; Design Operations; AI Workflow Adoption; Enterprise Product Design; Design Systems and Governance; UX Strategy; Cross-Functional Alignment; Workshop Facilitation; Product Discovery; Prototyping and Validation; Stakeholder Management; Remote Team Leadership.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Applaudo Studios — Remote, El Salvador

Senior UX/UI Designer & Mentoring Program Lead | Apr 2024–Present

- Lead portfolio design and mentoring for Bain & Company, supporting 9 designers with a verified 9.5/10 CSAT.
- Built Applaudo's design mentoring program.
- Created Design OS for Applaudo B2E work, spanning evidence, specifications, review, AI-assisted coded prototypes, and engineering handoff.
- Help teams adopt AI-enabled design practices using Cursor, Claude, and Figma Make.
- Partner with product owners, product managers, engineers, and designers; facilitate Design Thinking and UX consulting across distributed teams.
- Product work includes Bain Signal, PEG, TSG, NPS Prism, and Volaris iOS and Android.
- Delivered Dr ISSS / SalvApp for Google and the Government of El Salvador.
- Company recognition: Applaudo was named Google Cloud 2026 Partner of the Year for Public Sector, Latin America.

StratiFi Technologies — Part-time, Remote, San Francisco

Lead Product Designer | Mar 2024–Feb 2025

- Helped redesign the application and branding, raise capital, and create new business opportunities.
- Led opportunity discovery and translated market and user needs into requirements, prototypes, feedback cycles, and developer collaboration.
- Worked on financial risk technology used by investment advisors.

talPor — Remote, Chile

UX Consultant | Jun 2019–Apr 2024

- During the pandemic, created a methodology that accelerated client acquisition, reduced MVP delivery time while improving quality, helped the company survive and expand, and helped reach US and European markets.
- Led participatory discovery, field research, requirements, user flows, scenarios, wireframes, and prototypes.
- Client work included P&G, Xara Cloud, Finoa, and StratiFi.
- Used Miro, Slack, Loom, Figma, Sketch, and InVision.

Sinergia – Strategic Innovation Lab — Panama

Director / UX Strategist | Apr 2018–Dec 2023

- Directed the agency and led strategic design work across UX strategy, facilitation, and product definition.
- Work included e4cash and Academia Sinergia.

hipinspire

UX Art Director | Jul 2019–Jun 2020

- Led and mentored the creative team while directing UX and visual design.
- Client work included Udemy, GitLab, Zoom, Google, and Samsung.

Tumotorizado.com — Chile–Venezuela, Remote

Head of Design | Oct 2015–Oct 2017

- Led the design department, branding, and website and application redesign.

LEADERSHIP & TEACHING

Designlab — Freelance, Remote, United States

UX Design Mentor & Career Coach | Jul 2022–Present

- Teach through hands-on projects and one-to-one mentoring; 250+ Designlab students mentored.
- Guide students' progress and prepare them for UX careers.
- Support learners from introductory and immersion studies through real-client work and job readiness.

Crehana — Remote

UX Design Teacher | Dec 2015–Jan 2021

- Created and taught online UX courses for Latin American learners, including mobile app design and storytelling for UX.

CareerFoundry — Remote, Germany

UX Design Mentor | Mar 2022–Sep 2025

- Mentored learners in introductory and immersive UX/UI programs.

CERTIFICATIONS

Anthropic

- Claude Code in Action — Jul 2026
- Introduction to Model Context Protocol — Jul 2026
- Introduction to agent skills — Jul 2026
- AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations — Mar 2026

Product, Technology & Mentorship

- Crehana / UTEC — MicroDegree in Product Management — Jul–Dec 2021
- Platzi — Fullstack Web Development — Jan 2022–Jan 2023
- Platzi — Curso de Prompt Engineering con ChatGPT — Jun 2023
- Platzi — Inteligencia Artificial aplicada al Product Design — May 2023
- Platzi — Curso de ChatGPT para Product Designers: Diseño asistido por AI
- ADPList — AI Design Summit 2024 — Dec 2024
- ADPList — 1000 Mentorship minutes — Aug 2024
- ADPList — 25 Mentorship Sessions — Oct 2023

EDUCATION

- Crehana / UTEC — MicroDegree in Product Management, Jul–Dec 2021
- Platzi — Fullstack Web Development, Jan 2022–Jan 2023 (completed)
- Centro Instituto de Diseño Gráfico “Cidig” CA — Diseñador Gráfico, 2010–2013
- CIDIG — Especialista en Ilustración, 2010–2014
- INCES — Administrador de Empresas, 2007–2009

TOOLS & METHODS

Design: Figma, Miro, Sketch, InVision, Whimsical, Maze

Research: Typeform, Google Forms, Hotjar, Google Analytics

Collaboration: Notion, Slack, Loom, Google Calendar

AI / code-assisted: Cursor, Claude, Claude Code, Figma Make, Figma MCP, Design OS

Methods: Scrum, Design Thinking, Lean UX Canvas, Design Sprints, product discovery

LANGUAGES

English — Bilingual proficiency | Spanish — Bilingual proficiency

SELECTED LINKS

- Portfolio: https://adonaylizardo.com
- LinkedIn: https://linkedin.com/in/adonaylizardo
- UX Sidekick Chronicles: uxsidekick.substack.com